elaborate library on the left side of the entrance, adjacent to the household manager's room. From the ground floor, semi-circular steps led to a large garden with an expansive lawn where Ratan and Jimmy would play cricket.

Ratan's biological paternal grandmother, Ratanbai, stayed at the Zaveri Mahal apartment in Churchgate in the heart of Bombay with her two older sons, Jamasp and Shapur. Ratan remembers her as a 'very simple', well-meaning lady with an endearing personality. Ratan's maternal grandfather was an ebullient man, full of life. While he was the life and spirit of the Sunday get-togethers, his maternal grandmother was taciturn. She would sit quietly smiling through the party, enjoying the merriment—a streak that Ratan seems to have inherited.

The Schooling

Ratan began his education at Campion School, Bombay. For high school, he shifted to Cathedral and John Connon, an older institution in the city and one of the most famous in Asia. Here, Ratan faced some unusual problems. The school itself was 'too anglicized'; 'I never equated well with it' and was 'quite unhappy in Cathedral', he recalls. The young boy's problems were compounded by his mathematics teacher, who treated Ratan rather harshly. But he had a favourite teacher too: an Anglo-Indian, Glenn Howell, his geography and English teacher. Ratan scored exceptionally well in these subjects, which became his favourites. He was a member of Barham House, one of the four schoolhouses.

Ratan's parents had had a love marriage, a rarity in the socially conservative India and the equally traditional Parsi community of the pre-Independence era. But their whirlwind courting could not survive the normal vicissitudes of marriage and in 1944, they separated, with Soonoo moving to her parents' house. Soonoo filed for divorce and it was was a traumatic period for the children. Ratan was going on ten and Jimmy seven when they had to do many rounds of the family court. It was an 'unpleasant' and 'hurtful' experience, Ratan remembers. Soonoo eventually married Sir Jamsetji Jejeebhoy.Ratan says that separations or divorces did not happen 'every day' then as they do today. The rift between his parents was sensationalized and the details of their separation, both true and imagined, travelled fast. It became a topic of discussion in schools. Both Ratan and Jimmy were 'ragged' and humiliated in school by their peers. Ratan recalls